

WARLOCK

36



WARLOCK

TABLE OF CONTENTS

“Tick Tick Boom: The Kobold Trapsmith” by Sarah Madsen	2
“Traps for All: Kobold Class Traps” by Victoria Jaczko	9
“Warren Guild: All Hail Vinzlo (Now Pass the Pudding)” by HH Carlan	15
“A Shining City in the Deep Dark: Mysteries of Lillefor” by Wolfgang Baur	22

CREDITS

Designers: Wolfgang Baur, HH Carlan, Victoria Jaczko, Sarah Madsen

Developer & Editor: Scott Gable

Art Director & Graphic Designer: Marc Radle

Cover Artist: Bryan Syme

Back Cover Artist: Tyler Walpole

Interior Artists: Pedro Potier, Phil Stone

Publisher: Wolfgang Baur

Kobold Press, Midgard, Open Design, and their associated logos are trademarks of Open Design.

Product Identity: The following items are hereby identified as Product Identity, as defined in the Open Game License version 1.0a, Section 1(e), and are not Open Content: All trademarks, registered trademarks, proper names (characters, place names, new deities, etc.), dialogue, plots, story elements, locations, characters, artwork, sidebars, and trade dress. (Elements that have previously been designated as Open Game Content are not included in this declaration.)

Open Game Content: The Open Content includes the spells, feats, weapons and gear, and magic items. All other material is Product Identity, especially place names, character names, locations, story elements, background, sidebars, and fiction.

No other portion of this work may be reproduced in any form without permission.

© 2022 Open Design LLC

www.koboldpress.com



TICK TICK BOOM: THE KOBOLD TRAPSMITH

by Sarah Madsen

Kobolds are particularly fond of traps. And they've a sure knack at crafting bizarre contraptions and deadly devices to confuse and confound even the most skilled of adversaries. Feel free to come in and browse our glorious offerings—just watch your step.

Character Options

Presented here are numerous potential traps, spells, feats, and weapons for characters looking to raise their trapsmithing game. Though one does not need to be a kobold to utilize these features, kobold players will certainly want to take a look.

KOBOLD TRAPS

Never content with a basic foothold trap or tripwire, kobolds pride themselves on their particularly tricky and elaborate traps. While often these traps are made more complex than necessary, with seemingly unnecessary mechanisms and needlessly complicated triggers, many of them are subtle, sneaky, and deadly. A kobold trap that isn't comedically obvious and convoluted is a dangerous threat indeed.

Alley-Oop. The alley-oop is a classic spring trap laid beneath a 5-foot-square portion of a floor. A creature who steps on the trapped

area must make a DC 16 Dexterity saving throw. On a failure, the alley-oop springs upward, throwing the creature 15 feet in a random direction where they land prone, taking 2d6 bludgeoning damage. On a success, the character leaps clear as the trap triggers, landing on their feet in a space within 5 feet of the trap and taking no damage. Once the alley-oop has been triggered, it must be manually reset, requiring an action.

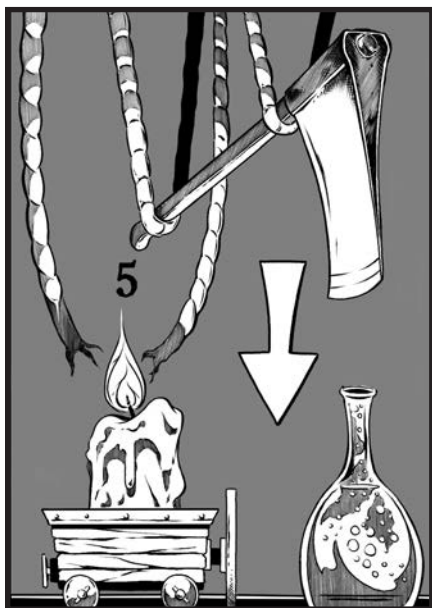
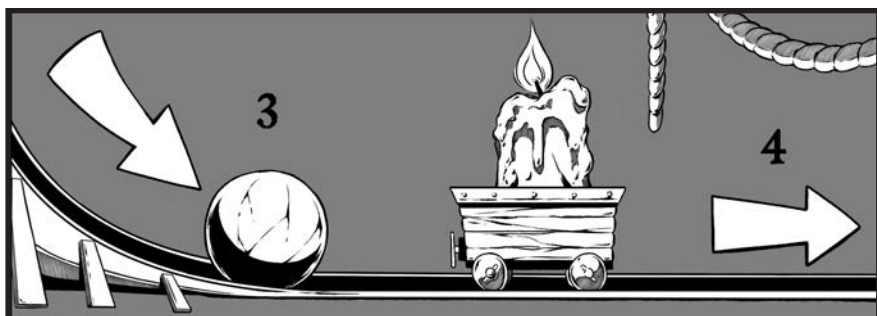
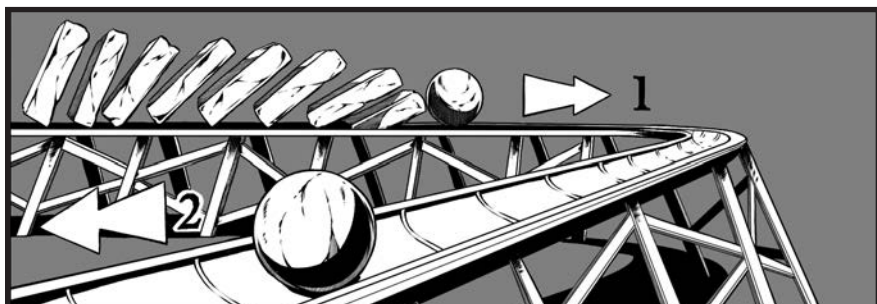
Noticing an alley-oop requires a successful DC 16 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check, though an alley-oop hidden beneath a rug or other camouflage might be harder to spot. Disarming it requires a successful DC 8 Dexterity (thieves' tools or tinker's tools) check.

Crafting an alley-oop requires the necessary materials, 25 hours of crafting time, and a DC 8 Dexterity check using tinker's tools.

Book Binding. A book-binding trap involves the use of a hollow book, tightly wound springs, and a folded, wire net. When the book is opened, the net springs outward and engulfs one creature within 10 feet in front of it. The target must succeed on a DC 18 Dexterity saving throw or be trapped by the net and restrained. A restrained creature can make a DC 17 Strength check at the end of their turn, breaking free of the net on a success.

A successful DC 18 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check notices the trap, and a successful DC 15 Dexterity (thieves' tools or tinker's tools) check is needed to disconnect the net

from the springs and disarm the trap. If the result of the Dexterity check is a 5 or lower, it triggers the trap, targeting the character attempting to disarm it.



A character may craft a book binding with the appropriate materials, 10 hours of crafting time, and a successful DC 12 Dexterity or Intelligence check using tinker's tools. More elaborate versions can be found or crafted, including those with spiked nets, dealing 5d6 piercing damage on a failed Dexterity save, or an electrified version that deals 2d4 lightning damage at the start of every round the creature is restrained. Crafting a more complicated version requires the appropriate materials, 20 hours of crafting time, and a successful DC 15 Dexterity or Intelligence check using tinker's tools.

No Soliciting. Kobolds who require their privacy may make use of a no-soliciting trap on their home. This trap consists of a bulb of hallucinatory gas triggered by the door's knocker. When triggered, a dose of gas is released from the bulb (typically hidden within the frame of the door or behind decorative foliage) and fills a 15-foot cone. Any creatures within the area must make a DC 13 Constitution saving throw. On a failure, they become frightened as their mind is filled with visions of horrible monsters, and they must use their full movement and the Dash action to move as far away from the door as possible by the safest available route on each of their turns. This effect lasts for 1 minute. A creature who starts their turn in the cone must repeat the saving throw. An affected creature may repeat the saving throw at the end of their turn, ending the effect on a success.

Discovering the no-soliciting trap requires a successful DC 12 Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check. Disarming the trap requires a successful DC 11 Dexterity (thieves' tools or tinker's tools) check.

Crafting a no-soliciting trap requires a bulb of hallucinatory gas, which can be purchased for 10 gp or created with 2 gp worth of materials and a successful DC 15 Intelligence check using alchemist's supplies. Each bulb contains six uses of gas before it must be

replaced. To install the bulb and rig the tripwire, a character must succeed on a DC 12 Dexterity check using tinker's tools.

Triple Threat. The triple threat is a devious kobold creation, involving three traps in one. Often, a creature will disarm or trigger the first trap only to trip the second trap without a thought. Not to be outdone though, the triple threat involves a third—and often more potent—trap, just for good measure (and for the amusement of the trapmaker).

An item or area trapped with a triple threat can be triggered three separate times, and each individual trap must be disarmed in sequence. When a character discovers the trap with an Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) check, the exact result determines how many they find: the first trap is detected on a result of 11–13, the first and second are detected with a result of 14–17, and all three traps are detected on a result of 18 or higher.

Similarly, disarming the traps requires three successive Dexterity (thieves' tools) checks, and the difficulty increases with each. Failing one disarm attempt resets all three traps (meaning a character must start over from the beginning). A character cannot disarm a trap they did not find though, so unless all three traps were discovered, one or more will inevitably be triggered. To disarm the first trap, a character must succeed on a DC 12 Dexterity (thieves' tools or tinker's tools) check. The DC for the second trap is 15, and the DC for the third is 17.

For example, a chest trapped with a triple threat may feature a poisoned needle, acid spray, and an explosive canister. The poison needle is triggered the first time a character attempts to pick the lock, the acid spray is triggered the second time a character attempts to pick the lock, and the explosive canister detonates when the lid is opened. Pressing on a hidden button on the side of the chest (DC 17 to locate) disarms the traps long enough to unlock and open the lid,

though they reset with a soft click when the lid is closed again. A character who triggers the poison needle must succeed on a DC 13 Dexterity saving throw or take 2d4 poison damage, and a character who triggers the acid spray must make a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw, taking 2d8 acid damage on a failure and half as much on a success. If the explosive canister is triggered, every creature within 10 feet of the chest must make a DC 18 Dexterity saving throw, taking 5d6 fire damage on a failure and half as much on a success.

Crafting a triple threat is not an easy feat and requires the necessary materials, 30 hours of crafting time, and three separate Dexterity checks using tinker's tools. Each check takes place after 10 hours of crafting, and a failure on one means a total loss on the project, requiring the character to start over from the beginning. The DC for the first check is 8, the DC for the second check is 11, and the DC for the third is 14.

TRAPSMITH SPELLS

Though much of a kobold's skill comes from tools and tinkering, the enterprising kobold trapsmith may go so far as to utilize magic to infuse and bolster their trapmaking.

ANALYZE DEVICE

2nd-Level Divination | Bard, Sorcerer, Warlock, Wizard

Casting Time: 10 minutes

Range: Touch

Components: V, S, M (a pinch of graphite)

Duration: Instantaneous

You spend 10 minutes magically inspecting a nonmagical device, weapon, or other piece of



gear, gaining insight into its inner workings without the need to disassemble it. You learn how to use the device, how it functions, and identify any hidden traps or triggers.

If you attempt to recreate the device within the next 48 hours, you can roll 1d8 and add the result to your crafting ability check.

DISMANTLE

3rd-Level Transmutation | Bard, Wizard

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: 30 feet

Components: V, S

Duration: Instantaneous

You target one nonmagical trap you can see within range and harmlessly disassemble it into its component parts, which hover in the air briefly before arranging themselves neatly on the ground in front of you. This disarms the trap without triggering it, though it does not allow elements of the trap to pass through solid barriers. For example, if a portion of the trap is hidden behind a stone wall, that portion remains in place or falls harmlessly to the ground, but it would not pass through the wall to get to you.

At Higher Levels. When you cast this spell using a spell slot of 5th level or higher, you can dismantle one additional trap for every two slot levels above 3rd (so two traps at 5th, three at 7th, and four at 9th).

INFUSE TRIGGER

2nd-Level Evocation | Sorcerer, Warlock, Wizard

Casting Time: 1 minute

Range: Touch

Components: V, S

Duration: Until dispelled or triggered

You infuse a mundane trap with arcane power, causing it to deal devastating magical damage. You can cast this spell on a nonmagical trap that deals slashing, bludgeoning, or piercing damage. When you cast this spell, choose a damage type from the following:

cold, fire, force, lightning, necrotic, or psychic. The trap deals an additional 2d4 damage of that type when triggered.

At Higher Levels. When you cast this spell using a spell slot of 3rd level or higher, the damage increases by 1d4 for each slot level above 2nd.

THIRD HAND

2nd-Level Transmutation | Bard, Druid, Sorcerer, Warlock, Wizard

Casting Time: 1 action

Range: Self

Components: V, M (a dried spider)

Duration: 1 hour

You grow a third arm and hand, gaining all the benefits that entails. The arm grows from your torso, though the exact placement is up to you. For the duration, the arm and hand function just like one of your own, and you can do anything with it you can do with your others, including carry items, activate items, or wield a weapon or shield, though the extra arm does not grant you any additional attacks or actions on your turn. Additionally, for the duration, you have a +4 modifier to all Dexterity checks made with artisan's tools.

TRAPSMITH FEATS

Feats available to kobold crafters.

EXPERT TRAPSMITH

Prerequisite: *Kobold with Proficiency in Alchemist's Supplies, Thieves' Tools, Tinker's Tools, or Smith's Tools*

When you make either a Dexterity or Intelligence check or saving throw using tools to craft or disarm a trap, you can add both your Dexterity and Intelligence modifiers to the roll.

NIMBLE

Prerequisite: *Kobold*

You are particularly adept at avoiding explosions—especially those you cause. When making a Dexterity saving throw to

avoid fiery explosions (like that caused by *fireball*), you double your Dexterity modifier for the saving throw.

TINKERED WEAPONS AND GEAR

Kobolds have a particular flair for the dramatic and the deadly—and that definitely extends to their weapons as well. Though many kobolds will use whatever is at hand, be it a sharp stick, a large rock, or a bag of stinging insects, kobold artificers and tinkers are constantly creating new weapons that are both terrifying and unpredictable.

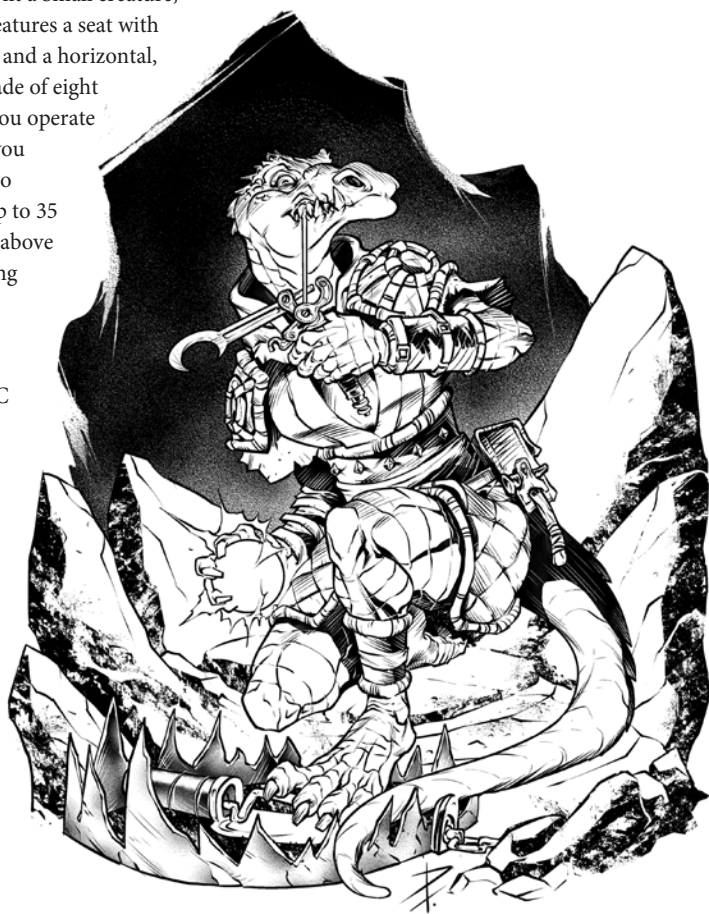
Blademill Cycle. Crafted by some crazed kobold weaponsmith, the blademill cycle combines a pedal-powered cart, a propeller... and swords. Sized to fit a Small creature, the blademill cycle features a seat with three wheels, pedals, and a horizontal, windmill-like fan made of eight longwords. When you operate the blademill cycle, you can use your action to pedal at a speed of up to 35 feet while the blades above you spin at a terrifying speed. Any creatures within 5 feet of you at the end of your turn must make a DC 14 Dexterity saving throw, taking 4d6 slashing damage on a failure or half as much damage on a success. If you are

proficient in land vehicles, the DC for the saving throw increases to 16.

A lever secured beside the seat allows you to brake while still spinning the bladed propeller or to deactivate and collapse the fan to use the cycle as a vehicle without using it as a weapon.

Crafting a blademill cycle requires 200 gp worth of materials, 15 days of crafting time, and a successful DC 8 Dexterity or Intelligence check using smith's tools or tinker's tools.

Boom Box. The boom box is an ingeniously simple (by kobold standards, anyway) contraption made of clockwork and filled with gunpowder. As an action, you wind the crank handle on the side to prime the



BOOM BOX SIZES

SIZE	AREA (RADIUS)	SAVE DC	DAMAGE	CRAFTING TIME	MATERIAL COST	CRAFTING DC
Tiny	10 feet	13	4d4 fire + 2d4 bludgeoning	5 days	50 gp	10
Small	20 feet	15	4d6 fire + 4d4 bludgeoning	10 days	100 gp	12
Medium	30 feet	18	6d8 fire + 4d6 bludgeoning	20 days	200 gp	14

box, and you can use a bonus action to set the notch-and-key timer up to 2 minutes (to a minimum of 1 second). Once the box is wound and the timer set, the gears inside tick down until the set time, at which point a flint-and-tinder mechanism inside sets the contents of the box alight, causing it to explode. When the box explodes, all creatures within the affected area must make a Dexterity saving throw, as determined by the **Boom Box Sizes** table, taking the bludgeoning and fire damage listed on a failed save or half as much damage on a successful one.

Some particularly maniacal kobold tinkers have taken to adding music box components to the boom box, so the mechanism plays a tinkling tune before it explodes.

Crafting a boom box requires gold, crafting time, and a successful Intelligence or Dexterity check using tinker’s tools.

Kobold’s Breath. Though kobolds lack the breath weapons of many of their draconic kin, a few daring kobold tinkers have crafted the next best thing. Roughly the size of a heavy crossbow, this two-handed weapon is a jumble of soldered metal, errant tubing, and glass bulbs. When fired, it sprays a 15-foot-long line of fire. Creatures in the line must succeed on a DC 14 Dexterity saving throw, taking 4d8 fire damage on a failed save or half as much on a successful one.

This weapon, while powerful, is not without its risks. When you use it, roll a d12 and consult the **Kobold’s Breath Failure Chance** table.

Crafting a kobold’s breath weapon requires 75 gp worth of material, 30 days of crafting time, and a successful DC 17 Dexterity or Intelligence check using tinker’s tools.

Various alternative versions of this weapon exist that deal acid or poison damage instead of fire.

KOBOLD’S BREATH FAILURE CHANCE

d12	RESULT
1	The weapon explodes in your hand and is destroyed. You take 8d6 damage of the weapon’s type.
2–5	Weapon functions but a piece falls off. Must be repaired (using an action) before it’s functional again.
6–12	Weapon functions as normal.

TRAPS FOR ALL: KOBOLD CLASS TRAPS

by Victoria Jaczko

Kobolds tend to utilize their natural dexterity, small size, and capacity for diabolically complex thinking when dealing with their enemies. Generally, this plays out as trapping the living daylights out of everything they can.

Typically, the kobold trapsmith works within a warren to trap it for the defense of their kin, protecting their homes and power base from intruders. Conversely, most adventuring parties can only make use of simple traps since life on the road doesn't lend itself well to making (or needing) complicated trap design. Some hunting traps, snares, or magical alarms and glyphs are usually the most a party needs, thus denying kobold adventurers some of their crafty expertise.

Well, not anymore! Below, each class receives a modification to one of their base features (or has it swapped out) in favor of a kobold-variant trap, incorporating the techniques or magic of that class. While these traps can be refitted for any game or for use by any character, they are intentionally given a kobold-flavored "charm" to them for kobold PCs and NPCs to add their characteristic deviousness to their class features.

Class Traps

Each class replaces one of their class features (or uses of one of their class features) with a custom, kobold-oriented trap. These are optional variant features and are subject to GM approval.

BARBARIAN

Kobold barbarians may not be as refined or complicated as their more urbane kin, but they retain a streak of draconic cunning and feral opportunism. The traps they devise may lack sophistication but are quick to craft, take advantage of natural terrain, and tend to hurt. A lot.

At 2nd level, instead of a barbarian's Reckless Attack feature, you can choose to take the Reckless Trap feature.

Reckless Trap. You can produce a trap incorporating scrounged or improvised materials appropriate to the terrain. Sample traps are falling logs, pits, snares, and rockfalls. It requires 10 minutes to set the trap, or 5 minutes if you rush (granting advantage on saving throws to avoid the trap).

Your traps are concealed within natural terrain and use local materials, giving other creatures disadvantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks to spot them. Your

traps' save DC is equal to 8 + your Dexterity modifier + your proficiency bonus, made against an appropriate saving throw for the type of trap, usually Dexterity or Constitution.

Your trap deals the damage customary for a trap of its kind plus an additional 1d8 of damage (even if it wouldn't normally cause damage). The extra damage increases by 1d8 at 6th, 10th, and 14th levels to a maximum of an additional 4d8 damage. You can choose for the trap to deal no damage if it wouldn't normally.

BARD

Kobold bards set traps with the intention of proving their sophistry and wit, caring less about damaging a foe than crippling the ego or proving a point. The bard is well-aware of the stereotypes and expectations other folk have about kobolds and use these misconceptions against them.

At 2nd level, instead of a bard's Song of Rest feature, you can choose to take the Mocking Song feature.

Mocking Song. As an action, you can conjure an illusion of a simple trap, such as a bear trap, trip wire, or a small glyph. The trap's illusory nature is revealed by effects that pierce illusions, such as *true seeing*, and it disappears if dispelled. Otherwise, setting off the trap or attempting to disarm it causes it to vanish and triggers a "song" of high-pitched yips and yaps that fill the area within 30 feet of the trap. A creature within the area of effect that can hear must succeed on a Constitution saving throw against your spell save DC or be deafened for 1 minute. Once you have used this feature, you must complete a short or long rest to use it again.

Starting at 11th level, any creature who fails its saving throw is also confused, as *confusion*, for 1 round.



CLERIC

Kobold clerics call upon their deities to safeguard just about anything they don't want anyone poking at. The small divine glyphs they conjure cause pain to those unwise enough to intrude upon their warren or tamper with their favorite pickaxe.

At 2nd level, instead of Channel Divinity: Turn Undead and Destroy Undead, you gain the Channel Divinity: Minor Glyph Trap and Major Glyph Trap features.

Channel Divinity: Minor Glyph Trap. As an action, you present your holy symbol and speak a prayer of protection over a nonmagical item no larger than 5 feet by 5 feet. This must be a specific item. You cannot target a section or floor or wall, but you can target a door or a window of an appropriate size. A glyph in the shape of your holy symbol glows on the item before fading,

but it remains visible for those looking for it or with a successful DC 10 Wisdom (Perception) check.

The glyph trap does not trigger if you touch or interact with the item, nor for up to five other creatures you designate when you set the trap. Any other creature who triggers the trap must make a Wisdom saving throw against your spell save DC, taking 1d10 + your cleric level of radiant damage on a failed save or half as much damage on a successful one.

The glyph trap does not harm the item it is on. It fades once triggered and must be reapplied at the next dawn, or it deactivates.

Major Glyph Trap. Starting at 5th level, your Minor Glyph Trap feature deals an additional 2d10 points of radiant damage when triggered. Additionally, when a creature fails its saving throw against your glyph trap, it is instantly blinded for 1 minute, and you are automatically alerted that the trap was triggered as a mental *alarm*, as long as you are on the same plane of existence.

DRUID

Kobolds are used to being overlooked and treated as lesser folk, so they're always ready to flip the tables. Druids kobolds, with their cunning and shapeshifting magic, can trap areas, attuning them to slithery and scaly things and laying low arrogant trespassers.

At 2nd level, instead of two uses of your Wild Shape feature, you gain one use of Wild Shape and the Baleful Marker feature.

Baleful Marker. You can spend a minute creating a marker out of natural materials, such as bone, wood, and feathers, and infusing it with magic. When placing the marker, you can designate a number of similar tokens, like feathers, stones, or carved items, in your possession to be keyed to the ward, granting immunity to creatures that possess one.

Creatures who enter within 20 feet of the ward and do not have a key token must make a Wisdom saving throw. On a failure, they are transformed into a Tiny beast, such

as a lizard, rat, or poisonous snake (your choice, set when you place the marker) as the *polymorph* spell for a number of minutes equal to half your druid level (rounded down). If such a polymorphed creature assumes their natural form while within the warded area, they do not have to make the save again, but they do if they leave and reenter. Beasts are immune to the marker's effects.

You can only have one Baleful Marker active at a time. If you construct and place a new one, your old marker is deactivated.

FIGHTER

Kobold fighters set few of their own traps, but they excel when surrounded by traps, whether set by kin, companions, or others.

At 1st level, instead of Second Wind, you gain the Spring Trap feature.

Spring Trap. As a bonus action, you can set off a trap within 5 feet of a creature you are currently engaging in melee and force them to be the target of the trap. You must be aware of the trap's existence in order to set it off. If the trap affects an area that you are within, you are also affected by springing the trap but have advantage on any saving throws it requires.

Once you use this feature, you must finish a short or long rest before you can use it again. You can use this ability twice between rests starting at 5th level, and three times between rests starting at 13th level.

MONK

Kobold monks focus less on spite in their traps, preferring to use their enemies' aggression against them. If reacted to calmly, a monk's trap is mostly harmless. Struggling against their trap, however, makes foes ever more ensnared.

Instead of the Step of the Wind Ki feature ability, you learn Calm Quicksand Trap.

Calm Quicksand Trap. You can spend 1 ki point to channel your energy into an area no larger than a 5-foot cube, creating an invisible space of quicksand-like energy that

lasts until the beginning of your next turn. Moving at normal speed or slower through the space does not trigger the trap. Running, casting a spell, making an attack, or taking similar actions within (or through) the space, however, activates the trap. The target must make a Wisdom saving throw against your save DC or be affected by the *slow* spell as the placid energy resists their aggression. The effect persists until the target takes no aggressive or hurried action for 1 round, or after a minute, whichever comes first.

PALADIN

The rare kobold paladin prefers to use traps to punish the truly wicked and unworthy, not to harass or injure simple interlopers. Drawing on their divine connection and heritage (as dragons are the ultimate symbol of judgment), the paladin ensnares enemies with a draconic sense of righteous fury.

At 2nd level, instead of the Divine Smite feature, you gain the Draconic Jaws feature.

Draconic Jaws. You can expend one paladin spell slot to lay a magical snare in an unoccupied space within 5 feet of you. This snare resembles a hunting trap but is obviously magical, bristling with energy and large teeth.

A creature stepping into the trap must succeed on a Dexterity saving throw against your spell save DC or take 1d8

piercing damage and 2d8 damage of one of the following: acid, cold, fire, lightning, or poison. The trap deals an additional 1d8 damage of the chosen energy type for each spell level higher than 1st, to a maximum of 5d8. Undead and fiends have disadvantage on their saving throw.

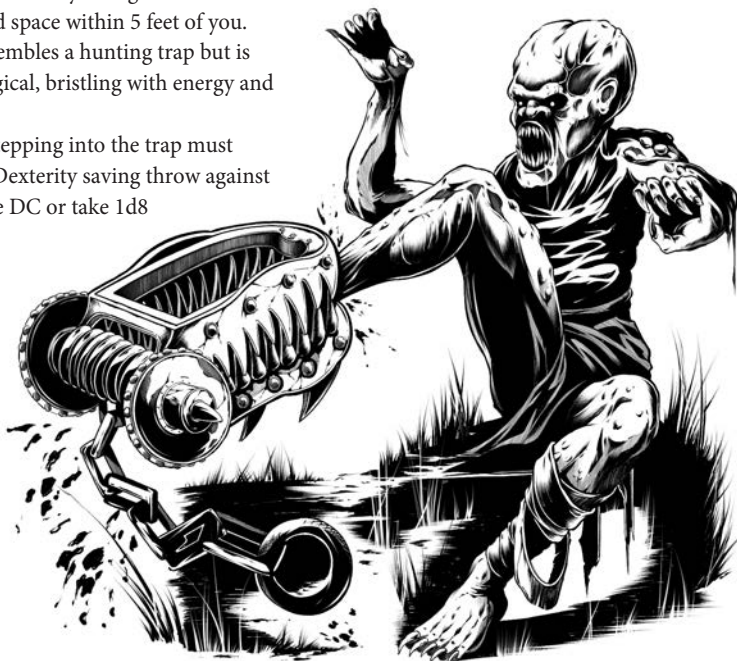
Creatures who fail their saving throw are also restrained. Freeing itself from the Draconic Jaws requires a successful Strength saving throw against your spell save DC.

The trap persists until a creature breaks free, the trapped creature dies, or until you complete a short or long rest, whichever comes first.

RANGER

Kobold rangers combine their natural affinity for cunning traps with a hunting acumen and adeptness within their preferred terrain. In favored environs, their traps are hard to find, harder to disable, and even harder to escape.

At 1st level, instead of the Favored Enemy feature, you gain the Favored Quarry feature.



Favored Quarry. You are particularly adept at creating and setting traps within your favored terrain and even more so at trapping particular types of foes. When you choose a favored terrain from your Natural Explorer feature, also choose a type of favored quarry: aberrations, beasts, celestials, constructs, dragons, elementals, fey, fiends, giants, monstrosities, oozes, plants, or undead, or, alternatively, select two races of humanoid (such as gnolls and orcs) as your favored quarries. This quarry must be commonly found in your selected favored terrain.

Traps you create or place in your favored terrain impose disadvantage on attempts to spot them with Intelligence (Investigation) or Wisdom (Perception) checks. Additionally, if your favored quarry sets off one of your traps, it has disadvantage on any saving throws made to resist or escape the trap.

If you are within a mile of one of your traps set in your favored terrain, you immediately sense when the trap is triggered, and the type of creature (animal, beast, gnoll, and so on) trapped in it, if any.

ROGUE

Kobold rogues have mastered the art of quickly manufacturing improvised traps with little to no planning and out of nothing more than materials at hand. They may be odd-looking and often break after a single use, but the rogue cares little about longevity compared to entangling foes in a snare made from a belt, scavenged wire, or the chain from a broken chandelier.

At 2nd level, instead of the Cunning Action feature, you can choose Cunning Traps.

Cunning Traps. You can take an action to create an impromptu trap of simple design: a hunting trap, snare, trip wire, and so on. As a bonus action, you can set a trap you've created in an appropriate unoccupied space within 5 feet of you. You can set the trigger for when the trap is contacted, when a specific space is entered or stepped on, or

when a certain amount of time has passed (no more than a minute).

The DC to spot, disable, or break out of your Cunning Traps is DC 8 + your Dexterity modifier + your proficiency bonus, and each trap has a saving throw appropriate to the trap's design (often a Dexterity saving throw).

Choose one of the following as the trap's effect: deal 1d6 + your rogue level in either bludgeoning, piercing, or slashing damage (appropriate to the trap) or cause the target to be grappled, prone, or restrained until the end of their next turn.

Complex traps, traps requiring significant preparation, or very large traps, like a huge, swinging blade, cannot be made with Cunning Traps. Likewise, at GM's discretion, a situation may render trapmaking impossible, like being completely naked in a totally empty room.

The trap breaks once triggered.

SORCERER

Kobold sorcerers empower traps with the magic of their own blood. A means of flexing their sorcerous mastery, their traps are personalized blood sigils used to ward walls, doors, and objects.

At 2nd level, you can spend your sorcery points to create a Blood Sigil.

Blood Sigil. As an action, you deal 1 piercing or slashing damage to yourself and draw blood to scrawl a sigil on a door, wall, floor, window, or item large enough to contain the sigil. You determine the sigil's appearance, and it radiates magic of the evocation school if targeted with an effect like *detect magic*.

Creatures who step on or over a sigil, touch it directly, step through a portal containing one, or pick up an item containing one trigger it. When triggered, the sigil erupts with magical energy. The creature that triggered it must make a Dexterity saving throw, taking 2d8 acid, cold, fire, lightning, or thunder damage on a failed saving throw (your choice when you create the sigil) or half

as much damage on a successful one. Once triggered, this sigil ends.

This sigil's damage increases by 1d8 when you reach 5th level (3d8), 11th level (4d8), and 17th level (5d8). Sigils crumble away after your next long rest unless you continue to invest sorcery points to keep them active.

WARLOCK

Kobold warlocks' patrons are fully aware of their affinity for baubles and cleverness. Warlocks can create pretty little trinkets with their magic and use them to lure the unwary into a trap.

At 2nd level, you do not gain Eldritch Invocations (instead learning your first invocation at 5th level) and gain the Invocation of Greed feature.

Invocation of Greed. As an action, you conjure a small bauble, such as a gem or a piece of jewelry no larger than your hand, infused with your magic. The bauble is fragile and likely to shatter if dropped or handled roughly, and it dissolves into smoke at the next dawn.

The magic of the bauble is inert while in your possession or held by you. Once it is either set down, taken from you, or given away, its magic activates. A humanoid creature within 30 feet who sees an unattended bauble must succeed on a Wisdom saving throw or use their action to move to the bauble and pick it up or, if they already hold the bauble, to examine it. The bauble then turns to smoke and clouds the target's mind, stunning them until the end of their next turn. On a successful save, the bauble simply turns to smoke.

WIZARD

Kobold wizards have plenty of magical options for traps and seldom resort to the mechanical variety their less erudite kin might employ. That said, their deviousness runs just as strong as any kobold, creating an interest in puzzle and riddle traps.

Instead of gaining the Savant feature as part of your Arcane Tradition at 2nd level, gain the Riddle Savant feature instead. (If your Arcane Tradition does not have a Savant feature, work out an appropriate feature replacement with the GM.)

Riddle Savant. Your crafty magic and fondness for complex riddles and puzzles can befuddle an opponent's mind. As an action, you can choose to speak a riddle aloud or to have a *minor illusion* of your voice recite or explain some manner of riddle or puzzle to a location you can see (including remotely, as with the *scrying* spell).

As long as the target is sufficiently intelligent and can understand you, it must make a Wisdom saving throw. On a failure, the creature is convinced it cannot perform an intended action (such as attacking you or opening a door or chest) unless it correctly answers the riddle, and it is compelled to spend each of its actions attempting to solve it. The creature makes an additional saving throw at the end of each of its turns. On a success, the creature is not compelled to answer and does not feel hindered from taking actions, though it may still choose to solve the riddle if it desires.

A creature attempting to solve your riddle or puzzle makes an Intelligence (Investigation) check against your spell save DC. If it succeeds, you can give it another riddle, and the creature will continue to attempt to solve it until it succeeds at its saving throw. Correctly answering a riddle grants the creature advantage on its next saving throw.

The compulsion ends 1 round after you leave the vicinity or stop responding to the target's attempts to solve the riddle or if you or your allies attack the target or cast a spell on it.

This feature automatically fails on creatures with an Intelligence of 4 or lower or who are immune to charm.

WARREN GUILD: ALL HAIL VINZLO (NOW PASS THE PUDDING)

by HH Carlan (with Sarah Madsen, Trappmaking Competition flyer)

Beneath the streets of Melana, there lies a second Melana: the sprawling Undercity, a complex system of tunnels and caves, buzzing with opportunity and, for the unsuspecting stranger, looming regret.

The dwarves of the city initially brought the kobolds in as cheap labor to work the mines and similar jobs, treating them like animals, but with the election of Censor Vinzlo, there came a new dawn for the kobolds, and they discovered hope. The Warren Guild is there to ensure their continued relevance and prosperity, to elevate the lives of the kobolds of Melana—by whatever means necessary, leaning in on their propensity for subterfuge and mischief.

TIME IS PUDDING

The Warren Guild have come to be known for their motto: “Time is pudding.” Vinzlo coined the original phrase, “Time is short, and victory is pudding,” on the eve of the great Raid of Garments, but now the kobolds recite their abbreviated motto as a call to arms. At the time, the canton heavily taxed pudding, so after the raid, after the kobolds stole the surface humans’ clothes, they feasted on tubs of prohibition pudding.

Guild Members

The Warren Guild’s roster boasts members from all kobold clutches within Melana, living and dead, as their ghosts are etched into the walls of the caverns and considered to be active members of society. Members range from seamstresses to assassins, and all the young kobolds complete an initiation on the eve of their tenth birthday. The newly admitted kobolds claim their assignments after tests which include rafting, sword-fighting, completing a labyrinth, and a pudding-eating contest.

The guild has need of kobolds of all stripes. At the helm of their crew reigns the beloved Archking Vinzlo, who sits in the largest tunnel on an intricate wooden throne. Now showing the signs of age, Vinzlo continues to oversee the activities of the guild through his daughters. Unlike his sons, who all took on combat roles, his daughters excelled early in leadership. Now, Vinelope oversees all trade, Vinchelle directs all social matters, and Vinarriet is the chief of strategy. Regardless of their direct command, all kobolds revere Vinzlo, and his word is final.

Two of the more infamous members of the Warren Guild maintain a credible and deadly reputation both in the Undercity and

The 3rd Tri-Annual Zobeck Kobold Trapmaking Competition

KOBOLDS ONLY

AMAZING CONTRACTIONS! EXCITING EXPLOSIONS! FANTASTASTIC PRIZES!

Sponsored by the Kobold Shipping Consortium!

- 1st Place: 200 gp and first dibs on the losers' scrap
- 2nd Place: 100 gp and second dibs on the losers' scrap
- 3rd Place: 50 gp (That's all, so do better next time!)

THE CONSORTIUM ARENA (GULLET)

Ceresday @ Sundown

Entrants must apply by DAWN on Ceresday and present their tools for inspection!
NO EXCEPTIONS!!

ENTRY FEE

Competitors: 10 gp per team

Spectators: 5 sp for safe seats, 1 cp for blast zone seats*

NO ANIMALS ALLOWED, ESPECIALLY DOGS

*Spectators sitting in the blast zone assume all risk and responsibility associated with sitting in the blast zone. Such risks include, but are not limited to, first-degree burns, second-degree burns, third-degree burns, acid burns, shrapnel injury, loss of sense of smell, loss of hair, loss of limb, loss of life. Ponchos (1 cp) and shields (2 cp) can be purchased on site or bring your own.

Risk also includes loss of poncho.

RULES AND REGULATIONS

Kobolds ONLY!

Clarification: Assistants can be non-kobolds, but the primary engineer must be kobold!

More Clarification: ASSISTANTS ONLY ASSIST, THEY DON'T BUILD!

You must bring your materials and tools with you. If it's not in your workspace when the starting gun goes off, you can't use it! There will be a pile of scrap for competitors to raid for extra materials. NO FIGHTING ALLOWED AT THE SCRAP PILE!

All items must be built from SCRATCH. No pre-building allowed!
THAT MEANS YOU, GERDA!

NO ATTACKING THE OTHER COMPETITORS OR THEIR ASSISTANTS!
No magic tools allowed!

Magic can be used **ONLY** to create materials, heat metal, or enhance triggers. Magic cannot be used to fabricate traps! **MAGIC CANNOT BE USED TO ATTACK OR INFLUENCE THE OTHER COMPETITORS OR THEIR ASSISTANTS!!** Judges are the final ruling on this!

NO ATTACKING THE JUDGES! MAGIC ALSO CANNOT BE USED TO ATTACK OR INFLUENCE THE JUDGES! LEAVE THE JUDGES ALONE!!

on Melana's surface. The first is a mapmaker whose knowledge of the surface rivals that of the most: Fingers is a smaller-than-average kobold with beautiful handwriting. He has drawn some of the most exquisite maps found in Melana—and will also write invitations for weddings when paid enough. His twin brother, Toes, is a pastry chef and thief who benefits from his brother's maps and informs him of the changes within the city. Both are slight, even for kobolds, and in their hands, their chosen utensils are also deadly weapons.

Life in the Warrens

Descending into the tunnels and eventually the warrens of the Undercity, travelers discover a confusing odor of sweet earthiness. The hollowed paths continue deep within the earth, and the seemingly ever-present smells of dessert permeate the galleries. Optimally carved for the physical dimensions of kobolds, taller creatures, including humans, must crouch or crawl through the tunnels, allowing the kobolds time to outrun enemies and quickly access the safety of their living quarters. The kobolds snicker and giggle at the too-talls navigating their homelands.

The grandest space within the warrens is the Doom Room. A sizeable cavern, tall enough for even a human to stand, the Doom Room is the strategy room where Vinzlo oversees the guild. Tables and bookshelves line the walls, trinkets and weapons fill the shelves—not a book is in sight. Hand-drawn maps



cover most surfaces, and though most have been drawn on by bored kobolds over the years, from longstanding games to mocking cartoons, they also contain useful notations and plans, such as for heists or trap design.

Since the ascension of Vinzlo, now archking and guildmaster, the kobolds are no longer banished to the shadows. Kobold society, supported within the Warren Guild, creates a robust subculture beneath the busy streets of Melana, composed of popular tradesmen, craftsmen, assassins, and proprietors of goods and services common, uncommon, and for enough coin, illegal.

BY THE FINE FINGERTIPS OF VINTINA

ASSASSIN'S LAMP

Wondrous Item, Very Rare (Requires Attunement)

A gold, gilded lamp with three transparent orbs that glow without flame. However, once attuned, the lights can be extinguished with their command word, casting *darkness* for all within range except for the attuned.

MURDER SPOON

Weapon (Shortsword), Very Rare

A standard wooden spoon with slots cut into its bowl to strain solids from soup, this spoon has a detachable handle that reveals an extending shortsword. You gain +1 bonus to attack and damage rolls made with this weapon.



Kobold Scheming

Pressured to create alliances with the surface dwellers, Vinelope tasked the older kobolds with creating intricate boxes and weapons, laced with traps and secret compartments. Through decades of refining their crafts, their works are now highly valued and sought after by those with the taste and means. Their works are attributed to the fictitious artist Zlokin and sold through surface connections. Travelers frequently ask Melana shopkeepers if they have anything new from the mysterious crafter. Believed by the locals of Melana to be the creator of their fine goods, this Zlokin has never made an appearance on the surface and is contacted only through the Warren Guild.

On occasion, a traveler might request a weapon made “by the fine fingertips of Vintina.” This is a code for assassins who wish to buy weapons crafted by Zlokin. If a shopkeeper has one in stock, they typically sell the mysterious weapon no matter the buyer. These weapons sometimes appear as harmless items, such as lamps and utensils, but they quickly reveal deadly capabilities

when in the right hands (see **By the Fine Fingertips of Vintina** sidebar).

The guild maintains alliances with other subterranean groups, relying on gossip and trade to further their goals. Common phrases heard in the Warren Guild are “friar’s poke,” which means something is good (such as it being a valuable deal or a positive outcome), and “looks like pudding,” which is code for impending conflict or combat. However, if a stranger passes through and talks about Zlokin, they are likely to be ambushed. It is rare for the Warren Guild to openly

ADVENTURE SEED: WHISPERS OF CHAOS

The Warren Guild have come to be known for their motto: “Time is pudding.” Vinzlo coined the original phrase, “Time is short, and victory is pudding,” on the eve of the great Raid of Garments, but now the kobolds recite their abbreviated motto as a call to arms. At the time, the canton heavily taxed pudding, so after the raid, after the kobolds stole the surface humans’ clothes, they feasted on tubs of prohibition pudding.

ADVENTURE SEED: COMMUNITY DOOMED

It's a warm night, and businesses in Melana have closed early due to rumors of an impending conflict. Threats of violence against Censor Seppo Voller and Merzlo Regon have the entire city on high alert. The entrance to the Undercity is flanked with heavy wooden crates, and as darkness settles, the crates explode, leaving the entrance in shambles and shaking the area. Merzlo was seen hiding among the buildings right before the explosion, and her guards are nearby. The entrance is destroyed, and thousands are now stranded belowground. Cries for help echo through the streets. How many will die tonight? Who will save them?

reference their secrets, so such a public misstep would be considered an attack and handled appropriately.

Vinzlo and Freigyrdown (a rising leader among the dwarves and member of the Freeholders, whose interests are not currently clear) are old friends and meet weekly at the Silver Crown to discuss their goals and how they can aid one another. Freigyrdown uses his connections to both ensure the kobolds

ADVENTURE SEED: VESPER'S SHADOW

Creaking floorboards ache beneath the heavy footsteps of a troubled man. "Nikswen's gone missing," Spire Dwell announces from the tavern stage. Rumors of the singer's disappearance had been building for days, and the only good lead is a mysterious woman seen about town. What the troubled proprietor is not mentioning is that his black book of secrets is also missing, which is problematic for the Warren Guild and the Freeholders if it fell into the wrong hands. Luckily, the last kobold to see her alive is sitting at the next table, and he has a story to tell.

stay supplied from the surface and to assist in the trade of the kobolds' unique crafted items.

SILVER CROWN TAVERN

The Silver Crown Tavern boasts a notorious reputation in the Undercity as the source of shady deals and even shadier patrons. The alliance between the Warren Guild and the dwarven Freeholders is not the only political intrigue in the Undercity, but if the barkeeps at the Silver Crown Tavern are approached by someone who means the Warren Guild or the Freeholders harm, they will more likely be served poison instead of ale.

The close relationship between the kobolds and Spire Dwell, the proprietor of the Silver Crown, means the tavern's kitchens have crafted a specialty pudding recipe after years of experimenting. Beloved by the Warren Guild, the recipe is proudly displayed in a gilded frame behind the bar at the tavern.

Enemies of the Guild

While the kobolds built a great friendship with the dwarves, they also created plenty of enemies to keep them busy. The foes of the Warren Guild come from all areas: surface and subterranean, flesh and fey.

- The greatest threats to the kobolds are the humans on the surface of Melana. Specifically, the humans of the vocal Temperance League—a political organization led by Merzlo Regon and her sycophants who espouse “peace” and “community”—secretly plot the demise of the Undercity and its inhabitants. Merzlo Regon is an ally to the leadership of Melana, but her personal agenda is to cause chaos and unrest between the surface and the Undercity. Her greatest ambition is to seal off the opening to the Undercity and forget it ever existed.
- The shadow fey linger throughout Melana and frequent the Undercity to

incite conflict. Motivated by their desire to sow chaos, for Zobeck in particular, and to see the mysterious prophecies come to fruition, the shadow fey typically do not attack, nor even show themselves undisguised, but instead orchestrate disaster from a distance and try to secretly insert themselves into society.

- A variety of subterranean creatures threaten the kobolds and their homes. **Pechs** (see *Creature Codex*) occasionally dispute territory boundaries and mineral veins with the kobolds and the dwarves. A **corpse worm** (see *Tome of Beasts 2*) lives at the edge of a frontier cavern where the kobolds throw their trash—and where many Undercity criminals throw their victims—and when it has not fed for a while, it attacks kobolds. A nest of **crypt spiders** (see *Creature Codex*) keep the corpse worm company and frequently hunt recently dead bodies or those close to death to bring back to their cavern.

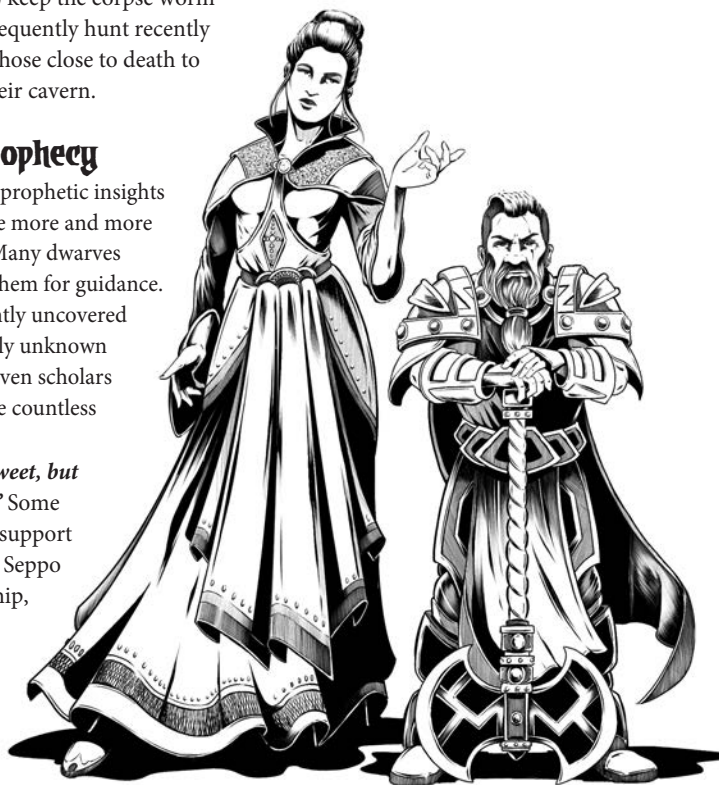
The King's Prophecy

The often seemingly prophetic insights of Relvina seem to be more and more relevant over time. Many dwarves continue to look to them for guidance. A mining crew recently uncovered a bundle of previously unknown fragments, and dwarven scholars vigorously debate the countless interpretations:

- **“Friendship is sweet, but Valor is divine.”** Some consider this to support a divine right to Seppo Voller’s leadership, and it stokes

the monarchists’ zeal. His detractors, however, still contend he is merely self-interested and exploiting his family lineage for personal gain.

- **“Trust the daughters for they carry the wisdom of mothers.”** Many kobolds and dwarves believe this passage speaks to capabilities and responsibilities of their daughters and they are prepared to make it reality.
- **“The gifts from the lizard people will bring peace to our land.”** The use of the word *gifts* causes some turmoil between the kobolds and the dwarves. The dwarves interpret it as a metaphor for skill and labor, but the kobolds interpret it as literal presents. So many kobolds focus on creating gifts, from folded paper dragons to bundles of reeds painted with the blood of enemies.



A SHINING CITY IN THE DEEP DARK: MYSTERIES OF LILLEFOR

by Wolfgang Baur

(with HH Carlan, *Odd Items of Kobold Traders and Kobold Delicacies tables*,
and Victoria Jaczko, *Report from the Ghetto and Kobold Tools*)

The kobold city of Lillefor lies deep in the underworld, far below the northern Margreve Forest and southern Morgau. Its walls and rushing waters shine like a jewel, glittering with the light of a hundred lantern beetles and dragonettes. While it is more than a week's travel from the surface, Lillefor's fame among kobolds is celebrated in songs and riddles. With a huge population to draw from, the scaled folk are strong enough to mine, build, trap, and tunnel far afield. Some consider it the first sign of a renewed kobold independence, a minor scaly kingdom in the Crossroads.

While most surface kobolds know of Lillefor, few will speak of it other than in the broadest terms—it is a sanctuary for them, a place of pilgrimage and safety, and the only city-state ruled entirely by kobolds. Indeed, in kobold tales and gossip, talespinners rarely mention it by name where any non-kobold might overhear. Instead, kobolds talk about Lillefor using circumlocutions such as “our little place” or “the shining city” or even “the floating town.”

Most kobolds rightly fear that if dwarves or humans found out about Lillefor's size and prosperity, they might strive to conquer it and oppress its people, as happened in Zobeck. The mines of Zobeck still exist, they

say, but their wealth flows only to humans, dwarves, and the fey. Not so with Lillefor.

A Brief History

The underworld city of Lillefor began as a mine, founded during the same period of kobold wealth and independence that unlocked the Great Silver Galleries under the Argental and that led to the founding of Zobeck as a surface mining camp. Miners from that period followed thin veins to the north, and they soon created a small but thriving colony devoted to silver mining with occasional strikes of mithral and veins of valuable gemstones.

The original founder's name is lost to history. The kobolds say a bandit king made the law at first, or possibly it was a darakhul lieutenant who led the kobolds to Lillefor's silver trove. Either way, that first human or darakhul was slain by an ambitious kobold warrior named Uluk Sama, who then claimed the mines and warrens in his own name. King Uluk the First is considered the first rightful king of Lillefor with his twin bride-queens, Dre-locca and Lyn-far, who served as the mine captain and watch captain, respectively. The trio ruled for an astonishing 20 years, until Uluk was ambushed and slain by a darakhul assassin.

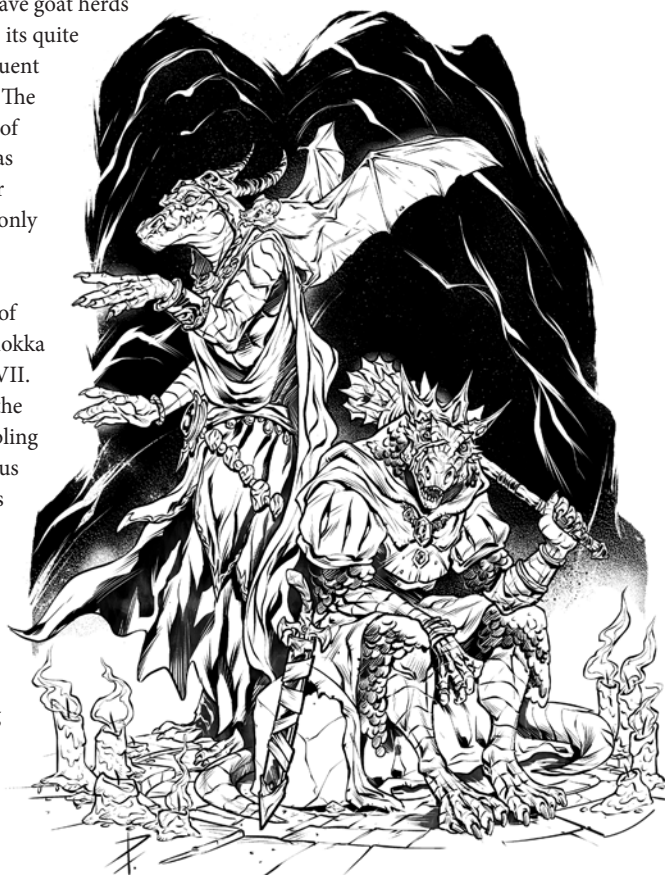
Some believe the first cavern was named Little Fort, and over time, this was shortened to Lillefor. More likely, the name derives from *lillesh*, meaning “silver” in Draconic. It certainly was a fortification at first, as derro, goblins, and even purple worms are cited as creatures “trapped and defeated” in its early days. Purple worm tunnels may have contributed to the growing city’s connections to the surface. The Purple Tunnel is still the main route to the surface today, though it is considered uncomfortably narrow for humans and dwarves.

Regardless of its early history, Lillefor has retained its independence and a certain level of secrecy. The camp’s access to an underground river and a thriving mushroom forest, bat colonies, and cave goat herds all helped it grow, despite its quite narrow passages and frequent attacks by purple worms. The kobold kings and queens of Lillefor are as numerous as those elsewhere, and their reigns are brief, typically only three to eight years long, occasionally a decade.

Two historical royals are of particular note: Queen Alokka Lyn III and King Junmo VII.

Queen Alokka allowed the construction of the Gambling Temple of Azuran and thus brought the Dragon Gods to the deep dark. This in turn led to the interest and guardianship of the mated cave dragons Hargo the Pale and Yuukfaad, who seized the temple, incorporating it into their nest, and adopted the city and its queen as their own minions and friends.

In later years, King Junmo decreed that derro and goblins would be allowed to settle in Lillefor, among the previously entirely kobold citizenry, in return for providing warriors to fight purple worms and protect the city’s livestock. These include **derro shadow antipaladins** (see *Tome of Beasts*) and **goblin mooncatchers** (see *Book of Ebon Tides*), some of them directly under kobold command, others called up by king and queen in time of need. The allied smaller races have often proven their worth against darakhul, dwarves, humans, and other foes over and over again—and the kobolds are delighted that they don’t have to do all the fighting themselves.



Through the City

Lillefor is vertically built on both sides of the Lillet River, a small but steady waterway that runs through the middle of the city-cavern. The kobold warrens are above river level, and inhabitants reach their entryways, balconies, and small ledges using a few large, public ladders and dozens of paths that are merely damp, stone handholds. The ladders can be easily removed in times of threat, and the handholds are difficult to climb without claws and daring—their spacing is best for Small creatures, and awkward for Medium and larger ones.

Terraces for growing mushrooms indicate the wealthiest inhabitants, and the king and queen live at the top of the cliff, surrounded by nobles and favored heirs in the Dragon Courts. The royal terraces are often the site of music, archery contests, and other festivals—and on occasion, the royals throw coins down the cliff to the poor.

KOBOLD WARRENS

The kobold homes each extend into the cliff, dug through the hard stone by pickaxe and stubborn kobold toil. Each entry tunnel branches into a warren with passages 3–4 feet tall, linking living chambers, natural grottos, goat caverns, and mining tunnels.

In addition, each warren entrance is protected by a trap or two, as is kobold tradition. Some traps are little more than rattling bones strung on twine or leather, and others are set only when the owner is away—and they can be quite deadly. “Dead at the doorway” is a common enough cause of death. Enough so that kobolds typically shrug and say, “They should have checked the tunnel first.”

TOO-TALL GHETTO

Because of Lillefor’s small tunnels and caverns, few tall races enjoy visiting. A short-term “touring token” can be purchased

at the entrances to town for 5 gp or more, and these permit a human, dragonborn, or other “too-tall” to visit the Lillefor Trade Quarter—a polite name for a damp, noisy ghetto of caves and huts built riverside. The trade quarter is often referred to as the Pack-Lizard Pen, though technically the tall-ceilinged caves are separate from the pack-lizard corrals. Nevertheless, many human, dragonborn, and dwarven visitors must first eject a lizard from their quarters before moving in themselves. Learning to ignore the ripe stench of the corrals takes some doing.

CITY GUARDIANS: DRAGONS AND BULETTE

The kobolds of Lillefor benefit from Scout-Captain Filloburta’s penchant for bringing monsters home to the city. The cave dragons at the royal court have been vital allies against darakhul and derro, the lantern dragonettes that nest on the river cliffs give the city light and character, and the bulette that dig in the hardest stone mines make it possible for kobold miners to extract far more silver and mithral than one might expect.

While the bulette are technically the property of the Lillefor army, in practical terms it is the Elder Miner and Chief Alchemist Jango Rikanrekko who trains, breeds, and controls them using soothing potions, verbal commands, and carefully controlled feedings.

His apprentice, the young and shy Rikansweldor, is learning all there is to know about bulette, for one of the city’s great fears is a repeat of the Days of Trampling some decades before Jango’s time, when the trainer and apprentice were both slaughtered by demons summoned in an unfortunate bit of royal sorcery. While that disaster led to the founding of the new dynasty under Kekarrac the Elder (also Kekarrac the Lucky or Kekarrac XIII), it also led to the more regimented training of bulette and their more methodical use in both mining and defense.

Floating Pods and Floating Temple

While much of the city is hidden in its warrens and tiny tunnels, humans and other visitors can all see the floating black pods that serve as helpful transport between the levels of the city. Also called puffbags or black floaters, these magical mushrooms are more-or-less flat and buoyant with a few tendrils drifting below them, somewhat like a jellyfish might have.

TRAVEL BY PUFFBAG

Boarding a puffbag to be lifted up the cliffside costs 1 sp for any kobold, 2 sp for larger creatures such as humans, and 4 sp for a pack lizard, and travel down to the river from the heights is free.

Each puffbag can carry its minder (usually an elderly kobold alchemist or a young mushroomfolk), plus 16 Small, eight Medium, or two Large creatures.

FLOATING PUFFBAG

Treat all puffbags as **boomer fungi** (see *Tome of Beasts 2*) with 140 hp and a flying speed of 20 feet vertically, or 5 feet horizontally. The kobolds do use their booming as a form of signal when the city is threatened, and puffbags make excellent platforms for spellcasters, archers, and slingers when the city is under attack.

Putting a Huge creature aboard a puffbag is not allowed and generally results in a catastrophic fungal explosion.

Each black floater is trained to rise and sink on command, and they take just a minute or two to go from the riverbed up to the heights of the Court of Dragons. Striking the puffbag or injuring it in any way results in a loud, booming noise, and the immediate attention of the city watch. Most often a fine of 200



gp or more is levied for anyone injuring, threatening, or mistreating a puffbag.

FUNGI OF AZURAN

The city puffbags are protected and fed by the priests of the Floating Shrine of Azuran, which itself sits on the back of one such floating pod. Its high priest, the rather unruly Kekel-Trekel, discovered the secret of these floating pods somewhere in the deep underworld, and he personally oversees their growth and care.

Each floating pod seems to live for one to two years before sinking permanently to the riverbanks and spawning hundreds of small puffbags. The spawning of the pods is usually a holiday for kobold children and parents alike, and the puffbags are perfect for games, puff races, and gambling.

After each spawning, the priests of Azuran collect the fastest, strongest, and toughest puffbags to grow into the next enormous floating pods of Lillefor via a secret process of feeding and enchantments. Queen Dre'Ssatoc herself is said to provide crucial binding enchantments for the harnessing and control of the pods, together with a myconid druid named Whitecap.

Ruler and Allies

King Kekarrac XIV and Queen Dre'Ssatoc are confident, sly rulers who have produced nearly two dozen heirs who vie with one another to be most favored. Many of them come and go as explorers and adventurers. They seek to buy the favor of family and the city's dragons and people with gifts, magic, and new wonders to entertain and feed the masses.

LILLEFOR, THE HIDDEN CITY

Symbol: A white shield with an eight-pointed blue star and a wavy blue border

Rulers: King Kekarrac XIV (LE **kobold king**, see *Creature Codex*) and Queen Dre'Ssatoc the Fair (LN kobold **archmage**)

Heirs & Nobles: 23 acknowledged heirs (treat as **kobold chieftains**, see *Tome of Beasts*), including the 10 princes (Crindos, Kekarrac the Younger, Lukki, Mallerac, Mandos-Ka, Pandos, Simorlac, Thorstan the White, Torban, and Ykra-Yelesh) and the 13 princesses (Azuranka, Bullanka, Dre-Baal, Dre-Clarsa, Dre-Kazba, Dre-Talla, Dre-Urkle, Marek-Tolla, Ninuye, Passye, Shaye, Uंबरla, and Xinka)

Important Personages: Elder Merchant Jiro (LN kobold **thief lord**, see *Creature Codex*); Elder Miner and Chief Alchemist Jango Rikanrekko (LE **kobold spellclerk**, see *Tome of Beasts* 2); Hargo the Pale and Yuukfaad (adult **cave dragons**, see *Tome of Beasts*) and their 12 dozen (young **cave dragons**, see *Tome of Beasts*); High Priest of Azuran Kekel-Trekel the Gambler (CN kobold **first servant** of Azuran, see *Southlands Worldbook*); High Priestess

of Baal Rezmal Truespark (NE kobold **first servant** of Baal, see *Southlands Worldbook*); Keeper of the Gates General Zuka the Bully (LE kobold **bandit lord**); Scout-Captain Filloburta Teranella (NG kobold **swolbold**, see *Creature Codex*); True Lantern Keeper Peepo Toddek (LN kobold **druid**)

Population: 48,000 (39,000 kobolds, 4,100 goblins, 3,000 derro, 900 dark folk, 900 myconids, 500 dragonborn, 400 lantern dragonettes, 200 shadow fey, and 15 cave dragons)

Strongholds & Temples: Cavern of the Bulette (kobold troops and heavy miners), Fiery Forge of Baal, Floating Temple of Azuran, Great Stalagmite Tower (bat rider stables), and Rava's Mill-Temple

Great Gods: Khespotan (patron), Azuran, Baal, Charun, Rava

Trade Goods: Silver ingots, cave salt, everlit lanterns, beetle armor, bulette shields, jasper and garnets, potions, puffbags, and mushroom bread (in order of importance)

COURT OF DRAGONS

The work of ruling the fractious city, its laws and justice, is done in the Court of Dragons, a palatial cave-warren large enough to house the royal cave dragons, powerful kobold royalty, plus a few dragonborn advisers, a flock of lantern dragonettes, and the best of Lillefor's families as squires, pages, secretaries, trapsmiths, scribes, and cooks. It is the largest warren of the city with more than 390 inhabitants, half of them of some noble blood.

The tunnels of the court themselves display kobold wealth and security, using wide-open space—which is a thing both terrifying yet status-enhancing to kobolds. Of particular note in large-form architecture is the Tenclaw

Audience Chamber, a single cavern that serves as a throne room with the royal seats roughly 20 feet off the ground in a balcony, looking down at visitors below. The balcony itself resembles a dragon's head with ten large claws below it.

Royal audiences are not like those in most surface palaces. For instance, the court's cave dragon wyrmlings are often fed a goat or two during an audience with the king and queen (visitors find this distracting, which is probably the point). Lantern dragonettes and lantern beetles provide strong light from niches in the walls or small nests atop stalagmites while pixie's umbrella fungi float about the chamber, making for a chaotic and somehow strangely enchanted space.



Rumors claim that sometimes Hargo the Pale and Yuukfaad magically assume the form of the kobold king and queen and rule in their stead. Others claim that Hargo and Yuukfaad are kobold heroes who have ascended directly into semi-divine, draconic form.

DIPLOMATIC CONNECTIONS

The city rulers maintain distant but cordial connections to the Ghoull Empire and even more distant (but more cordial) connections to the Mharoti Empire. More often, they speak and trade with the Kobold Kings of Zobeck and sometimes with the goblins of Fandeval in the Shadow Realm. They send occasional emissaries to Baba Yaga or to the Red Queen of Courlandia, and that seems like more than enough attention to the Upper World for their liking.

The Lillefor kobolds maintain no formal connection to the Ironcrag Cantons, to the Blood Kingdom of Morgau, or to the Magdar Kingdom. They are sworn enemies to the

gnomes of Niemheim, always happy to betray them to Baba Yaga.

While the cave dragons and kobolds rarely speak of it, they are enemies not just of gnomes and purple worms but also of the expansionist Ghoull Empire. From time to time, a ghoul patrol vanishes near Lillefor, perhaps devoured by cave dragons or slipped into a fiery magma trap. It is nothing so bold as a war, but when ghouls come too close to kobold territory, they are not welcomed.

Trade and Inhabitants

While much of the city focuses on creating a place for the smaller races to trade and thrive far from humans and darakhul, it still maintains a surprising amount of trade with neighbors in the underworld and on the surface. Lillefor’s merchants and explorers carry raw materials and worked goods into Morgau and Krakovar, the Ironcrag Cantons, the Magdar Kingdom, and (most of all) to the Free City of Zobeck. The trade with Zobeck,

ODD ITEMS OF KOBOLD TRADERS

d6	ITEM
1	Ice Statue. An iron statue of an owl in flight, the surface drops to freezing when touched by a warm-blooded creature, dealing 1d3 cold damage. It can expend this cold energy once per day and recharges at dawn. (3,000 gp, 85 lb.)
2	Measuring Cups. This set of nested measuring cups appears normal enough, but they are incapable of providing correct measurements as they constantly expand and contract when used. Not designed to do much other than ruin someone’s day, the measuring cups are a treasured gag gift among the kobolds. (50 gp, 1 lb.)
3	Moss Finger. The small green tube snugly fits on the finger of a kobold or other Small humanoid. It can shoot a sticky silken strand up to 60 ft., up to 3 times per day. The thread attaches to any stone or metal surface and can bear up to 50 lb. (1,000 gp, 1/4 lb.)
4	Spikeball. Two spiked, perfectly balanced metal balls are connected with a woven cord that slips around a finger. When a wearer makes a melee attack against a foe within 5 ft., they can use a bonus action to deal an additional 1d3 slashing damage. (500 gp, 1/4 lb.)
5	Toy Box. Designed for a child, this wooden box can easily hold an assortment of toys. However, the curved lid also has a false panel (DC 12 to discover), revealing a drawer for weapons sized for kobolds. (200 gp, 25 lb. when empty)
6	Wet Candles. Candles of dark-blue wax, these are designed to glow even when submerged in water or other translucent, nonflammable liquids. They burn for 10 minutes when submerged and cannot be reused. (50 gp, 1 lb.)

while substantial, is largely invisible to the humans and dwarves of Zobeck. Rather than taking their subterranean goods to the marketplaces directly, the kobolds sell them to the Zobeck kobolds—who then pass them off as their own. Thus, the Zobeck ghetto seems to be an almost miraculous source of metal, jasper, and other goods.

MINERS AND MUSHROOMS

At the head of the Mercantile Brotherhood are Jiro the Explorer and Elder Miner and Chief Alchemist Jango Rikanrekko, who provides much of the metal and gemstones to merchants for trade. The merchants are skilled at loading up enormous pack lizards and mules to carry their silver, gems, coarse salt, and fine, worked devices to Zobeck and elsewhere and to bring back wine, silks, fine paper, and other goods.

In addition, the city has a small group of crucial mushroomfolk partners, the Wide

Hat Clan. These include barbarians, druids, and rangers, who care for the city's bats, cave goats, and mushroom foodstocks, such as by caring for **boomer fungi** in entrance tunnels and producing **pixie's umbrella fungi** and **strobing fungi** for festivals (see *Tome of Beasts 2* for all three fungi). In return, the mushroomfolk are protected from the more dangerous creatures of the underworld.

THE LANTERN GUILD

Of as much note as the Merchant Guild, the Miner's Guild, and the Alchemists Guild is the Lantern Guild. They raise **lantern beetles** (see *Tome of Beasts 2*) and **lantern dragonettes** (see *Tome of Beasts*), which they sell to derro, dwarves, shadow fey, and shadow goblins along with lamp oils, magical mirrors, and many other items of kobold enchantment.

The living lights are at the heart of the guild—as much from tradition as anything

KOBOLD DELICACIES

d8 MENU ITEM

- 1 **Cave Fish Sushi.** A thin cut of raw cave fish, wrapped in fried snakeskin with a wild yam mash and served with a spicy mushroom aioli, this is a rare treat brought out on special occasions. (1 sp per piece, or 5 sp per 6-piece platter)
- 2 **Charred Fun Shrooms.** A warm treat that reminds even the most hardened kobold of their childhood, this fungus, when properly cooked, is no longer lethal while still retaining a mild hallucinogenic effect. Kobolds frequently adjust cooking times for too-talls to desired result. (4 cp per serving)
- 3 **Gristle Chips.** Fried to sizzling crisps and salted, these chips are made from shavings of whatever meat scraps are available, especially from tougher and older portions. (1 cp per serving)
- 4 **Kobold Milk Tea.** Whatever milk is on hand, usually ant, roach, or worm, is simmered and used to steep assorted spiced tea blends. (1 cp per mug, or free with additional purchase)
- 5 **Pudding Cups.** A kobold favorite, these are miniature pudding trifles of varying flavors. They are common at festivals. (4 cp per mug)
- 6 **Spiced Dirt Beans.** Fermented for years while buried in the dirt, these spiced beans provide a filling and flavorful meal. Earthy notes and the sweetness of the mold are well complemented by whatever fatty meat scraps are available. (1 sp per serving)
- 7 **Trash Juice.** This concentrated bone stock includes any number of whatever spices and vegetable castoffs become available. Great for sauces and marinades, many kobold kitchens keep a giant, perpetual pot, simmering constantly in a quiet corner, simply adding to it as needed. Also warming on a cold night! (3 cp per mug, or 5 cp with shot of spirits)
- 8 On second thought . . .

Report from the Ghetto

Good evening, my glorious kin of the Zobeck Ghetto! This week's issue is brought to you by Creeli's Emporium of Legitimate Lockpicking Apparatuses and by the personal winnings of yours truly from . . . working, just from my regular wages. Anyway! On with the scuttlebutt skittering through our warrens.

MAYOR OLLECK HUNTING SMUGGLERS!

It's been brought to our attention that undercover members of the city watch have been spied on the northeast side of the ghetto along the Derry, looking for smugglers taking advantage of our chain bridges to evade taxes! We should, as good citizens, mind our own business and leave them to do their work, and do not, under any circumstances, distract them by scuttling across the street in the shadows and setting enormous rat traps for them to investigate while some other enterprising young kobolds hook up additional bridges to the north and south.

WORKSHOP EXPLOSION UNDER INVESTIGATION!

In the late pre-dawn hours of last Torsday, a multi-colored explosion rocked the warrens north of the royal workshops. Preliminary investigation revealed none of the workshops themselves are damaged, but a suspicious crater among the homes across from the apothecary has some locals asking questions. Timrod the Mighty, a young kobold recognized for his colorful robes, specialty goggles, and a persistent odor of sulfur, insists the crater has been there since before the reign of Kuromak VII, but his neighbors have refuted this on the basis that, "Timrod is an idiot alchemist who ate too many of his own concoctions." Also, "Look, he burned down half my wall while I was making a late-morning rat on a stick."

The investigation continues, but inquiry suggests questioning has turned away from whether Timrod the Mighty actually blew up his home and has focused more on what ingredients it took to make the explosion bright pink and green.

REWARD OFFERED FOR LOST TREASURE!

Aggreta Darkscapes has offered a reward of 27 cp and a vial of an unknown substance that is, "Either a potion of healing or an experimental cleaning solution. I can't remember which," for the return of her favorite broom, which has the names of her ancestors etched into the handle. Aggreta says it should be easily recognizable by the petrified mouse nailed to the top of the handle.

That's all for this week! As always, this report comes from Debbik, your faithful chronicling kobold of the Ghetto. Until next time! All hail King Quetelmak! Until someone else replaces him, anyway.

practical (for many casters can conjure some form of light). Lantern dragonettes are considered lucky animals, and if one allows a person to feed or touch it, that person is considered a “dragon-friend” and gains respect among the kobolds of Lillefor.

The guild’s leader, True Lantern Keeper Peepo Toddek, oversees lantern making, beetle breeding and hatching, and dragonette training. Most of his time, is lately devoted to strobing fungi and luminescent paints. The other guildmasters and journeymen think perhaps it is time for a change.

Kobold Tools

Kobolds have a unique relationship with their tools. Their favorites are designated as unmistakably theirs with a mix of decorative touches, unique (and mostly useless) modifications, and even partial damage. Throw in a predilection for giving their equipment proper names, and it’s a rare kobold found without a signature item of some kind that they guard with jealousy. Roll a d20 four times and consult the **Kobold Unique Tool Generator** table, or choose from the entries to create an appropriate tool.

KOBOLD UNIQUE TOOL GENERATOR

d20	ITEM TYPE	FEATURE	FIRST PART OF NAME	SECOND PART OF NAME
1	Axe	Attached fangs	[Choose a color]	[Same as Item Type]
2	Chisel	Bows and ribbons attached	[Kobold name]	Bleeder
3	Cooking utensil	Cheap gem inlays	[Same as Item Type]	Breaker
4	Crossbow/bow	Covered in Draconic runes	Brilliant	Bringer
5	Crowbar	Decorative feathers and bones	Claw	Carver
6	Hammer	Decorative rust	Clever	Destroyer
7	Instrument	Dragon carving/etching	Clutch	Device
8	Knife/dagger	Extra, unnecessary handle	Dark	Eater
9	Lockpicks	Faintly glows in the dark	Dragon	Finder
10	Mace/warhammer	Glued-on insect wings	Ever/Eternal	Fixer
11	Magnifying glass/spyglass	Gnawed-on handle	Excellent	Fury
12	Needles	Name written on it	Fang	Greed
13	Pen/prush	Painted, garish colors	Glorious	Helper
14	Pickaxe	Partially burned	Hollow	Mover
15	Polearm	Pitted with acid scars	Imperial	Seeker
16	Shears	Pointless chains/strings attached	Magnificent	Stabber
17	Shovel	Reeks of sulfur	Quick	Thing
18	Staff/club	Sparkly with gem dust	Rock	Trap
19	Sword	Wrapped in dead vines/flowers	Scale	Wrath
20	Roll twice*	Roll twice*	Roll twice*	Roll twice*

(*) keep both options and consider how they are put together, such as a staff with a spyglass attached to one end like a portable telescope or an item named Red Eternal Thing-Bleeder.

OPEN GAME LICENSE Version 1.0a

The following text is the property of Wizards of the Coast, Inc. and is Copyright 2000 Wizards of the Coast, Inc ("Wizards"). All Rights Reserved.

1. Definitions: (a) "Contributors" means the copyright and/or trademark owners who have contributed Open Game Content; (b) "Derivative Material" means copyrighted material including derivative works and translations (including into other computer languages), potation, modification, correction, addition, extension, upgrade, improvement, compilation, abridgment or other form in which an existing work may be recast, transformed or adapted; (c) "Distribute" means to reproduce, license, rent, lease, sell, broadcast, publicly display, transmit or otherwise distribute; (d) "Open Game Content" means the game mechanic and includes the methods, procedures, processes and routines to the extent such content does not embody the Product Identity and is an enhancement over the prior art and any additional content clearly identified as Open Game Content by the Contributor, and means any work covered by this License, including translations and derivative works under copyright law, but specifically excludes Product Identity. (e) "Product Identity" means product and product line names, logos and identifying marks including trade dress; artifacts; creatures characters; stories, storylines, plots, thematic elements, dialogue, incidents, language, artwork, symbols, designs, depictions, likenesses, formats, poses, concepts, themes and graphic, photographic and other visual or audio representations; names and descriptions of characters, spells, enchantments, personalities, teams, personas, likenesses and special abilities; places, locations, environments, creatures, equipment, magical or supernatural abilities or effects, logos, symbols, or graphic designs; and any other trademark or registered trademark clearly identified as Product identity by the owner of the Product Identity, and which specifically excludes the Open Game Content; (f) "Trademark" means the logos, names, mark, sign, motto, designs that are used by a Contributor to identify itself or its products or the associated products contributed to the Open Game License by the Contributor (g) "Use", "Used" or "Using" means to use, Distribute, copy, edit, format, modify, translate and otherwise create Derivative Material of Open Game Content, (h) "You" or "Your" means the licensee in terms of this agreement.

2. The License: This License applies to any Open Game Content that contains a notice indicating that the Open Game Content may only be Used under and in terms of this License. You must affix such a notice to any Open Game Content that you Use. No terms may be added to or subtracted from this License except as described by the License itself. No other terms or conditions may be applied to any Open Game Content distributed using this License.

3. Offer and Acceptance: By Using the Open Game Content You indicate Your acceptance of the terms of this License.

4. Grant and Consideration: In consideration for agreeing to use this License, the Contributors grant You a perpetual, worldwide, royalty-free, nonexclusive license with the exact terms of this License to Use, the Open Game Content.

5. Representation of Authority to Contribute: If You are contributing original material as Open Game Content, You represent that Your Contributions are Your original creation and/or You have sufficient rights to grant the rights conveyed by this License.

6. Notice of License Copyright: You must update the COPYRIGHT NOTICE portion of this License to include the exact text of the COPYRIGHT NOTICE of any Open Game Content You are copying, modifying or distributing, and You must add the title, the copyright date, and the copyright holder's name to the COPYRIGHT NOTICE of any original Open Game Content you Distribute.

7. Use of Product Identity: You agree not to Use any Product Identity, including as an indication as to compatibility, except as expressly licensed in another, independent Agreement with the owner of each element of that Product Identity. You agree not to indicate compatibility or co-adaptability with any Trademark or Registered Trademark in conjunction with a work containing Open Game Content except as expressly licensed in another, independent Agreement with the owner of such Trademark or Registered Trademark. The use of any Product Identity in Open Game Content does not constitute a challenge to the ownership of that Product Identity. The owner of any Product Identity used in Open Game Content shall retain all rights, title and interest in and to that Product Identity.

8. Identification: If you distribute Open Game Content You must clearly indicate which portions of the work that you are distributing are Open Game Content.

9. Updating the License: Wizards or its designated Agents may publish updated versions of this License. You may use any authorized version of this License to copy, modify and distribute any Open Game Content originally distributed under any version of this License.

10. Copy of this License: You MUST include a copy of this License with every copy of the Open Game Content You Distribute.

11. Use of Contributor Credits: You may not market or advertise the Open Game Content using the name of any Contributor unless You have written permission from the Contributor to do so.

12. Inability to Comply: If it is impossible for You to comply with any of the terms of this License with respect to some or all of the Open Game Content due to statute, judicial order, or governmental regulation then You may not Use any Open Game Material so affected.

13. Termination: This License will terminate automatically if You fail to comply with all terms herein and fail to cure such breach within 30 days of becoming aware of the breach. All sublicenses shall survive the termination of this License.

14. Reformation: If any provision of this License is held to be unenforceable, such provision shall be reformed only to the extent necessary to make it enforceable.

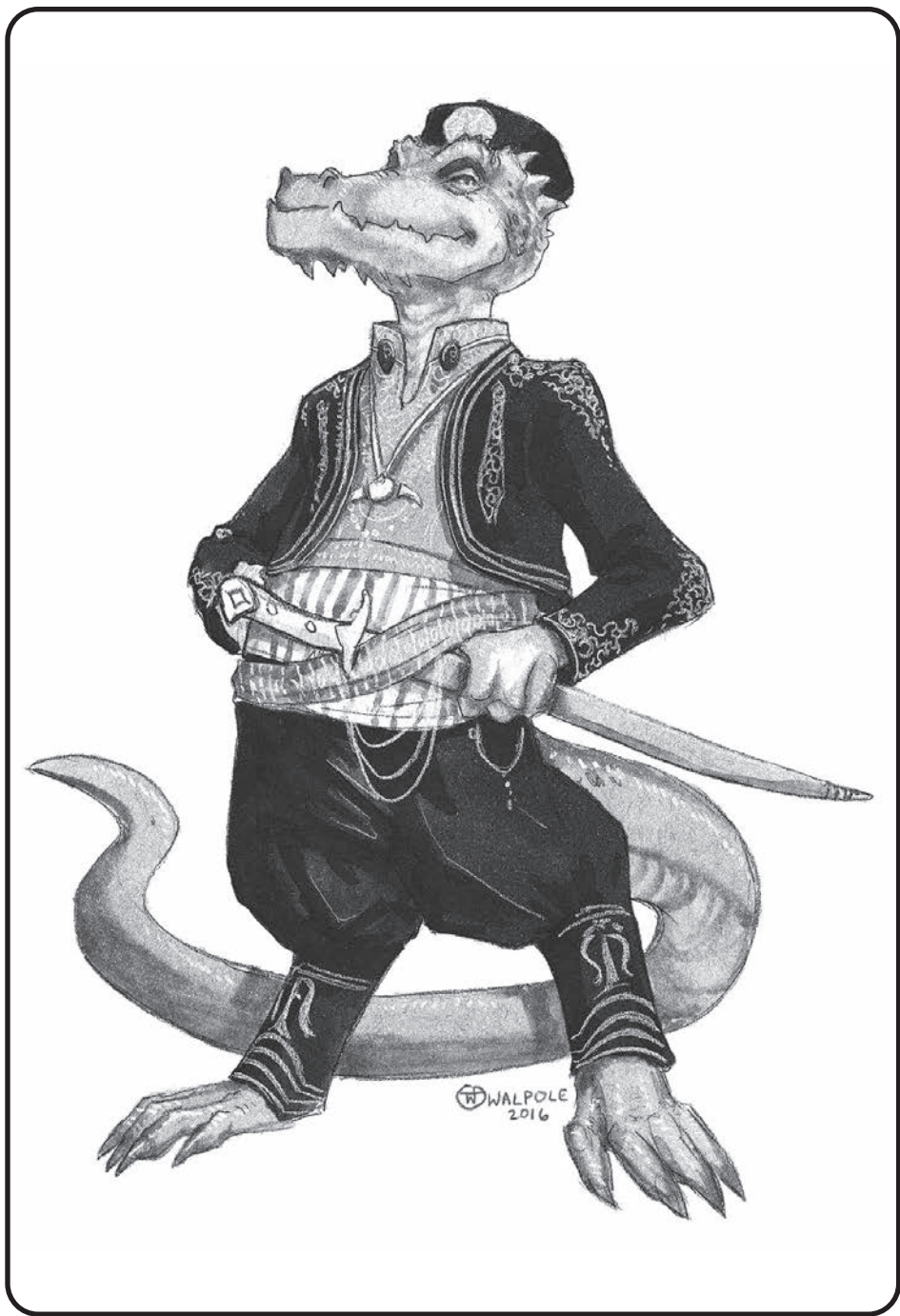
15. COPYRIGHT NOTICE

Open Game License v 1.0a Copyright 2000, Wizards of the Coast, Inc.

System Reference Document 5.0 Copyright 2016, Wizards of the Coast, Inc.; Authors Mike Mearls, Jeremy Crawford, Chris Perkins, Rodney Thompson, Peter Lee, James Wyatt, Robert J. Schwalb, Bruce R. Cordell, Chris Sims, and Steve Townshend, based on original material by E. Gary Gygax and Dave Arneson.

Warlock 36: Kobolds. ©2022 Open Design LLC.

Authors: Wolfgang Baur, HH Carlan, Victoria Jaczko, Sarah Madsen.



KOBOLD
Press

SUPPORTED BY
PATREON

\$9.99
Printed in USA